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Islamic values that are not in our **Surroundings**

There are explorations of some Islamic value that are not be fully upheld in Pakistani society:

1. Justice

Islamic Perspective: Justice is a core tenet of Islam, encapsulated in the Quranic injunction to stand firmly for justice, even if it goes against oneself or one's kin.

In Pakistan: Despite legal frameworks, issues like corruption, nepotism, and unequal treatment can lead to significant disparities in how justice is administered. People with power or resources may receive preferential treatment, undermining the ideal of equal justice for all.

2. Equality

Islamic Perspective: Islam teaches that all humans are equal in the eyes of God, regardless of race, ethnicity, or social status. The Prophet Muhammad's Last Sermon emphasizes this equality.

In Pakistan: Cultural practices sometimes create divisions based on caste, class, or gender. Women and marginalized communities may face discrimination that contradicts the Islamic principle of equality, affecting their rights and opportunities.

3. Compassion

Islamic Perspective: Compassion is a fundamental aspect of Islamic ethics, encouraging kindness towards all creatures. The Quran describes God as “The Most Merciful.”

In Pakistan: While charitable giving (Zakat) is practiced, there can be a lack of day-to-day compassion in personal interactions. This can manifest in neglecting the needs of the poor or being indifferent to the suffering of others.

4. Truthfulness

Islamic Perspective: Honesty is highly valued in Islam, with the Prophet Muhammad being referred to as "Al-Amin" (the Trustworthy). Lying and deceit are condemned.

In Pakistan: Despite the emphasis on truthfulness, dishonesty can be prevalent in business dealings, politics, and social interactions. This can lead to a culture of mistrust and ethical dilemmas.

5. Respect for Women

Islamic Perspective: Islam granted women rights and protections that were revolutionary for its time, including rights to inheritance, education, and participation in society.

In Pakistan: Cultural practices, such as patriarchal norms and gender-based violence, can undermine women’s rights and dignity. Societal attitudes may prioritize traditional roles over women’s empowerment and autonomy.

6. Community Welfare

Islamic Perspective: Islam promotes the idea of Ummah, or community, where individuals are responsible for the welfare of one another. This is reflected in practices like charity and community support.

In Pakistan: While charity is common, there may be a lack of sustained efforts to address systemic issues like poverty or education. Individualism can sometimes overshadow communal responsibilities.

7. Forgiveness and Reconciliation

Islamic Perspective: Forgiveness is a virtue in Islam, with numerous verses in the Quran encouraging it as a means to achieve peace and harmony.

In Pakistan: Social conflicts, feuds, and grudges can persist due to cultural norms favoring retribution over reconciliation. This can lead to cycles of violence and hostility that are contrary to Islamic teachings.

8. Humility

Islamic Perspective: Humility is essential in Islam, as indicated in the Quran and the Hadith. Believers are encouraged to be modest and avoid arrogance.

In Pakistan: Materialism and status can lead to a culture of pride and arrogance, where social standing is prioritized over moral character. This can foster divisions and a lack of genuine connection among people.
